

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY
B.Com. (Hons.) — Semester I Examination, 2023-24

Paper No. BCHE-111: English Language

Time: 3 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

Instructions: Answer all questions as indicated.

Question 1. Write a letter of inquiry to a firm of furniture dealers requesting their price list and catalogue. [10]

OR

Write a letter of inquiry to a supplier asking about the price and time of delivery of Raincoats, Overcoats, and Gumboots. [10]

Question 2. Write a job application letter to a leading MNC as a fresher applying for the post of Business Management Trainee. [10]

OR

Write a letter to your employer requesting casual leave for a specified duration, stating a valid reason. [10]

Question 3. Write a letter to the Editor of a daily newspaper highlighting the issue of open manholes in your locality. [10]

OR

Design a newspaper advertisement offering paying guest accommodation near the university campus for female students. [10]

Question 4. Make a précis of the following passage and suggest a suitable title: [10]

“On one occasion in Russia, after a battle, a famous surgeon wanted to attend to the wounds of a general first. Napoleon groaned: ‘Your duty’, he said to the surgeon, ‘is to attend to all the wounded and not to anyone in particular’. In Russia, when the victorious hoofs of a horse were about to go over the dying body of a Russian soldier, one of Napoleon’s generals said, ‘Oh! This is only a Russian soldier’. Napoleon lifted up the body of the dying man. He said: ‘After victory we have no Russians or Frenchmen. They are all men.’”

Question 5. Explain, with reference to the context, any three of the passages given below: [12]

- (a) “Come blessed barrier between day and day,
Dear Mother of fresh thoughts and joyous health!”
 - (b) “Having been so long without proper food, a bath, and a change of clothing, I did not, of course, make a very favourable impression upon her.”
 - (c) “It is not growing like a tree
In bulk, doth make Man better be;
Or standing long an oak, three hundred year,
To fall a log at last, dry, bald, and sere :”
 - (d) “My mother only said:
Thank God the scorpion picked on me
and spared my children.”
 - (e) “You could melt down all the gold medals and cups I have, and they wouldn’t be a plating on the 24-carat friendship I felt for Luz Long at that moment.”
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Question 6. Answer any five of the following questions in brief: [10]

- (a) What does the author of *The Book of Nature* hope his letters will do for the reader?
 - (b) What is Schatz’s state of mind at the end of the story in *A Day’s Wait*?
 - (c) “This is becoming monotonous.” Who said these words and about what?
 - (d) Luz Long is said to be the epitome of Coubertin’s ideal. What was Coubertin’s ideal?
 - (e) Something added to Washington’s discomfort while he was waiting for admission. What was it?
 - (f) Why does the poet describe the time of sleep as ‘blessed’?
 - (g) Why did the villagers want to paralyze ‘the Evil one’ in *Night of the Scorpion*?
 - (h) What idea does the Lily stand for in *The Noble Nature*?
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Question 7. Match the words in Column A with their meanings in Column B: [4]

oprule Column A	Column B
(a) Pirate	(i) Differing or changing
(b) Commence	(ii) Begin
(c) Varying	(iii) Sea robber
(d) Stillness	(iv) State of silence without movement
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Question 8. Fill in the blanks in the following sentences with appropriate forms of the words in italics: [4]

- (a) He *laughs* heartily and his _____ is heard all through the house.
- (b) Gandhi *enjoyed* a good joke. He wanted others to share his _____.
- (c) He is a great *political* worker. But his brother is not interested in _____.
- (d) He *arrived* at the meeting at the wrong moment. On his _____ he found that all his followers had left the place.